

NIKHIL PRADHAN

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PROFILE

Operations and strategy professional who builds markets where none exist and then brings public finance in behind them. Founded ApiCare, an agri-enterprise in Sikkim, India, that organised 125+ smallholder producers into a working supply chain and was selected by the Government of Sikkim as a private-sector partner under RAMP — a World Bank-financed MSME programme the state implements. Five years of last-mile delivery in a regulated, audited environment, working where digital tools meet operators who have never used one. MBA in Impact Entrepreneurship (Erasmus Mundus), with a thesis platform linking traceability to producer credit access.

SELECTED EVIDENCE

- **Zero** — audit findings across every RAMP review cycle (Government of Sikkim secretaries, with KPMG as coordinating body)
- **125+** — smallholder producers mobilised, trained and integrated into an aggregated supply chain across three Himalayan districts
- **6** — SMEs digitalised end-to-end from no prior digital presence; 300,000+ engagement touchpoints generated
- **5** — training locations delivered under a Government of Sikkim capacity-building work order (Jul 2026 – Mar 2027)
- **EUR 22,000+** — direct-to-consumer revenue built from zero: sourcing, pricing, inventory, logistics and channel design
- **USD 15,000** — milestone-linked recoverable grant facility secured through investor-grade documentation

DEVELOPMENT OPERATIONS & PUBLIC-PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP

ApiCare Organic Pvt. Ltd — Founder; Operations, Product & Strategy

Sikkim, India · Jan 2021 – Present

Agri-enterprise in India's only fully organic-certified state. Selected by the Government of Sikkim, Dept. of Commerce & Industries, as a private-sector partner under RAMP — a World Bank-financed MSME programme the state implements.

- Mobilised 125+ smallholder beekeepers across three districts into an aggregated supply chain — recruitment, training, quality control and offtake — creating the commercial base that public investment later scaled
- Delivering a Government of Sikkim capacity-building programme under RAMP across five training locations (Jul 2026 – Mar 2027): curriculum, scheduling, participant tracking and reporting, with KPMG as coordinating body
- Coordinated compliance between Government of Sikkim secretaries and KPMG auditors across all RAMP review cycles — zero findings in every audit
- Built the downstream market from zero: direct-to-consumer and export channels, pricing architecture, inventory and logistics — EUR 22,000+ revenue
- Preparing EU export entry: Eurofins residue and quality certification, provenance documentation and compliance paperwork
- Built departmental relationships with the Sikkim Dept. of Commerce & Industries, securing support for organic certification and origin-protection initiatives for Sikkim honey

DIGITAL & TOURISM DELIVERY

Hotel Poreč (HP Duga) — Erasmus+ Traineeship, Content & Digital Production

Poreč, Istria, Croatia · Jun – Jul 2026

- Built a two-engine destination content strategy (prestige and reach) for a Croatian coastal hotel group, producing tourism content and visual assets for international markets
- Produced destination content across the Parenzana cycling trail and the Istrian hill towns of Motovun, Grožnjan and Završje — research, structuring, copy and visual assets
- Produced video and photographic assets end-to-end in DaVinci Resolve and Lightroom

Independent Consultant — Digital Product Strategist & Business Development Lead

Sikkim, India · Mar 2023 – Jul 2025

- Deployed end-to-end digital infrastructure for 6+ hospitality SMEs — WordPress builds, eZee channel manager integration, OTA onboarding and booking automation — converting manual operations to digital systems

- Generated 300,000+ engagement touchpoints through full-funnel digital strategy (SEO, Meta Business Suite, Google Analytics), tracked against performance dashboards

SELECTED PROJECT

FarmLedger — Traceability & Producer Credit Records Platform

MBA thesis and operating platform · 2026 – Present

- Architected on one principle — digitize the transaction, not the farmer: each verified sale becomes underwritable evidence rather than a predicted score imposed on the producer
- Records the trades a producer makes with customers, businesses and FPOs; multimodal AI turns that transaction history into a credit profile a lender can underwrite against
- QR-linked producer verification — GPS coordinates, certification status, AI-assisted quality grade and a plain-English audit trail — built on Azure AI Foundry with a structured data backend

EDUCATION

- Erasmus Mundus Joint Master's — MBA in Impact Entrepreneurship | ZSEM (Croatia) · ISM (Lithuania) · HEC Liège (Belgium) | Sep 2025 – Dec 2026 | Top 1% global scholarship
- B.Tech — Electronics & Communication Engineering | Sikkim Manipal Institute of Technology | 2019

SKILLS & TOOLS

- Delivery & operations: PPP structuring, capacity-building delivery, stakeholder management across government and multilateral programmes, compliance and audit frameworks, KPI tracking
- Data & analysis: Python, SQL, Advanced Excel, financial modelling, Google Analytics, performance dashboards
- AI & digital: Azure AI Foundry, OpenAI API, prompt engineering; DaVinci Resolve, Lightroom; Notion, Jira, Asana, Agile, Lean
- Languages: English (fluent) · Hindi · Nepali · French (A2, working toward B1)

Post-study work rights from December 2026 — Belgium (search-year residence permit) and the Netherlands (Orientation Year Permit, Erasmus Mundus clause). No employer sponsorship required.